

Students sue university over webcam-monitored exams

**DUB** |

Foto: Pixabay

The Central Student Council of the University of Amsterdam has begun preliminary proceedings against the university for its use of surveillance software during online examinations. Depending on the outcome, the case could have repercussions for the rest of Dutch higher education.

NEWS

By [HOP Translation Taalcentrum-VU](#)

on 06/03/2020 - 14:27

[Read in Dutch](#)

Privacy complaints about online invigilation have been piling up since the start of the corona crisis. Youth organisations [voiced their concerns](#), and the House of Representatives weighed in on the issue as well. So far, two universities of

applied sciences have openly [distanced themselves](#) from the hotly debated monitoring software.

The University of Amsterdam (UvA) has not: it expects to hold another two hundred online exams using Proctorio invigilation software before the end of the spring semester. The software uses students' webcams to monitor them as they take their exams at home.

The Central Student Council is now bringing the matter to court, [reports](#) student magazine Folia. The Council feels that students should be able to refuse the use of Proctorio during online exams without incurring study delays.

Under the Dutch Higher Education Act, new exam methods [cannot be used without the consent](#) of the central councils and faculty councils. In April, the Central Student Council of the UvA issued a negative recommendation on the use of Proctorio, but the university's Executive Board decided to use the software nevertheless. The Council hopes that participation councils at other institutes of higher education will also benefit from the preliminary proceedings.

Difficult to predict

The case will be brought before the Amsterdam District Court on Thursday. The students' chances of winning the suit are difficult to predict, says Paul Zoontjens, professor of education law at Tilburg University. "If the university can make it clear that it has neither the staff nor the facilities to hold exams in any other way, the judge will be sensitive to that. But if the students can demonstrate that other institutions do offer alternative options, that could sway the case in their favour."

The question remains whether the students are going about this the right way, as there is also a [national committee](#) for these kinds of disputes, to which the council could have turned first. "It won't help their case if it turns out they did not approach the committee", says Zoontjens.

Minister of Education Ingrid van Engelshoven (D66) seems unsympathetic to the privacy concerns raised with regard to online invigilation. Earlier this year, she [called on](#) the participation councils to show adaptability and flexibility "where necessary" during the corona crisis.

TAGS: CORONAVIRUS | PROCTORING | PRIVACY | ONLINE EDUCATION

Share this article



Wat vind jij hiervan?

0 Antwoorden



Leuk



Grappig



Geweldig



Verbaasd



Boos



Verdrietig

0 Reacties

Inloggen ▼

G

Start de discussie...

MELD AAN MET

OF REGISTREER JE BIJ DISQUS



Delen

Beste Nieuwste Oudste

ADVERTISEMENT

STUDENTEN



HUISARTS



HEB JE AL EEN HUISARTS IN UTRECHT?
NEE? IS GEWENST!
SCHRIJF JE NU GEMAKKELIJK ON-LINE IN!



studentenarts.nl

[Search](#)

[Newsletter](#)

[About DUB](#)

[Privacy](#)



The independent news site of Utrecht University